

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Could you be more explicit?



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can compare different aspects of jobs in a conversation with a colleague.
- I can deal with communication breakdown.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- What are some things that make communication difficult at work?
- What do you do when there is oral or written communication breakdown at work?

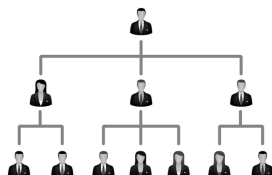




Let's Explore!

Kristi and Adam talk about **hierarchical*** versus flat structures in companies.

* "Hierarchical" is an adjective. It describes something that is organized vertically (top-down). The noun is hierarchy.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Adam:** You never mentioned that you worked at Polygon. That's a big deal! How'd you like it there?
- Kristi:** It was interesting and definitely different from how they work around here.
- Adam:** What do you mean, interesting?
- Kristi:** Well, Boris mentioned that BFP Publishing follows a flat structure. Polygon followed a hierarchical structure.
- Adam:** Uh? I'm not following you. Could you be more specific?
- Kristi:** For starters, a flat structure does not have as many levels as a hierarchical one.
- Adam:** So, are you saying a hierarchical structure is like a pyramid?
- Kristi:** Yeah. A hierarchical company is as complex as it gets.
- Adam:** I see. Could you elaborate a little more on that?
- Kristi:** Well, a flat company is not as bureaucratic as a hierarchical one. Employees work as one large team reporting to one boss.
- Adam:** I don't quite see what you're getting at. Could you give me an example?
- Kristi:** To say this differently, in a flat company you don't have as many divisional structures as in a hierarchical one. People might have several reporting lines.
- Adam:** I get it. Does that mean your job responsibilities are not the same as the last job?
- Kristi:** Correct. My responsibilities now are not as clearly defined as in my last job.
- Adam:** Could you be more explicit?
- Kristi:** In other words, I have to be flexible and prepared to do a variety of different tasks, as opposed to doing only one task all the time.
- Adam:** I think I get it now.
- Kristi:** It's a cross-functional team ...
- Adam:** Sorry, Kristi. You lost me again. Could you explain what you mean by cross-functional?
- Kristi:** To put it differently, my job involves working with people with different functional expertise. We are all working toward a common goal.
- Adam:** It does sound like a really exciting job!



Let's Practice!

Adam deals with communication breakdown.

Instructions: Complete the expressions by matching a half from the left to one on the right.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. What do you mean, | a. an example? |
| 2. I'm not | b. what you're getting at. |
| 3. Could you be more | c. interesting? |
| 4. Could you elaborate | d. specific? |
| 5. I don't quite see | e. following you. |
| 6. Could you give me | f. by cross-functional? |
| 7. Could you explain what you mean | g. a little more on that? |



Let's Practice!

Kristi talks about a company's organization.

Instructions: Find the words in the word search below.

Words

1. functional
2. hierarchical
3. flat
4. structure
5. divisional
6. bureaucratic
7. report to
8. responsibilities
9. expertise
10. tasks

L	F	Q	Z	G	P	G	E	D	V	Y	B	D	J	A	B	N	F	C	L
X	I	F	U	N	C	T	I	O	N	A	L	V	E	D	L	H	H	B	E
D	U	T	S	E	D	H	F	W	V	M	G	Q	U	I	S	D	I	H	X
W	S	U	X	K	W	I	X	C	C	I	S	R	X	V	S	B	E	I	P
A	R	G	R	O	X	L	V	B	O	C	C	E	B	I	J	P	R	F	E
C	K	S	T	R	U	C	T	U	R	E	W	P	O	S	G	K	A	U	R
U	W	G	W	W	Z	Q	Y	E	H	S	R	O	B	I	T	N	R	P	T
D	V	N	D	X	Y	R	U	Q	R	W	D	R	W	O	W	M	C	D	I
N	A	M	S	F	Y	Z	G	Z	O	V	C	T	W	N	H	J	H	Q	S
A	T	A	S	K	S	T	P	A	A	W	G	T	C	A	O	R	I	O	E
I	J	S	K	B	L	P	T	H	B	O	B	O	H	L	B	O	C	I	N
W	N	Z	F	M	S	C	K	K	R	U	Q	A	O	Q	M	E	A	P	B
F	L	K	Y	O	T	B	S	H	E	S	B	U	I	H	R	Y	L	M	U
A	F	L	A	T	B	E	P	B	Y	Y	Y	B	N	X	S	W	S	W	J
H	X	K	X	S	D	I	K	K	S	M	I	U	W	C	L	Z	Y	N	R
S	G	R	E	S	P	O	N	S	I	B	I	L	I	T	I	E	S	D	C
P	E	H	J	C	Q	A	Z	Q	U	F	T	Y	H	Y	Q	A	U	G	U
C	R	B	U	R	E	A	U	C	R	A	T	I	C	P	D	D	A	I	J
L	W	G	C	S	W	W	N	N	L	I	O	R	J	S	L	Y	S	E	M
S	B	Q	J	T	X	X	Z	A	R	J	J	M	C	D	W	G	E	S	N



Extension Activity

Compare two jobs that you have had or the jobs two different people have.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, discuss different jobs you have had (salary, level of responsibility, stress, tasks, hours, etc.).
- Choose two jobs. Discuss how they were the same or different.
- Write 5 sentences describing how the jobs are similar or not similar. In your sentences, use expressions like *as...as* and *not as...as*.
- Decide which job was the better. Explain why.
- Read your sentences aloud.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss different jobs.

☐ ☐

I write sentences comparing jobs.

☐ ☐

I read the sentences to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- flat structure** (noun): a way of organizing a company with many people sharing responsibility, reporting to one boss
e.g. Boris mentioned that BFP Publishing follows a flat structure.
- hierarchical structure** (noun): a way of organizing a company with the responsibility following a vertical chain from top down
e.g. Polygon followed a hierarchical structure.
- complex** (adjective): containing many different interconnected parts
e.g. A hierarchical structure is as complex as it gets.
- to report to** (verb): to work for (the person you report to is the person who evaluates you)
e.g. Employees work as one large team reporting to one boss.
- divisional** (adjective): separated into sections
e.g. In a flat company you don't have as many divisional structures as in a hierarchical company.
- functional** (adjective): organized according to role
e.g. My job involves working with people with different functional expertise.





Learning Points

Making Comparisons: *as ... as* and *not as ... as*

When you want to compare things, you don't have to use comparative adjectives. You can use two different structures instead. Varying your language in this way makes your writing and speaking more sophisticated.

When you want to compare the qualities of two things that are equal, you use the structure ***as + adjective + as***.

For example:

*Maria is **as tall as** her sister.*

*I am **as qualified as** the boss.*

When you want to compare the qualities of two things that are not equal, you use the structure ***not as + adjective + as***.

For example:

*France is **not as sunny as** Bali.*

*A flat company is **not as bureaucratic as** a hierarchical one.*

Examples:

- *My responsibilities now are not as clearly defined as in my last job.*
- *A flat structure does not have as many levels as a hierarchical one.*





Learning Points

Modals and Expressions to Ask for Clarification

In a workplace setting, when you are not sure what someone has said, you can use different expressions to ask for clarification. These are polite.

Here are some expressions you can use to ask for clarification.

What do you mean, _____?

I'm not following you.

Could you be more specific?

So, are you saying _____?

I don't quite see what you're getting at.

Could you give me an example?

Does that mean _____?

You lost me again.

Could you explain what you mean by _____?

Examples:

- *Could you elaborate a little more on that?*
- *I don't quite see what you're getting at.*
- *Could you give me an example?*

